INCH-POUND
MIL-DTL-5898H
w/AMENDMENT 4
12 June 2024
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-5898H
w/AMENDMENT 3
27 January 2022

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

CORDS, ELECTRICAL
(WF-5/U, WF-14/U, WD-34/U, WM-53/U, WM-85/U)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments
and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

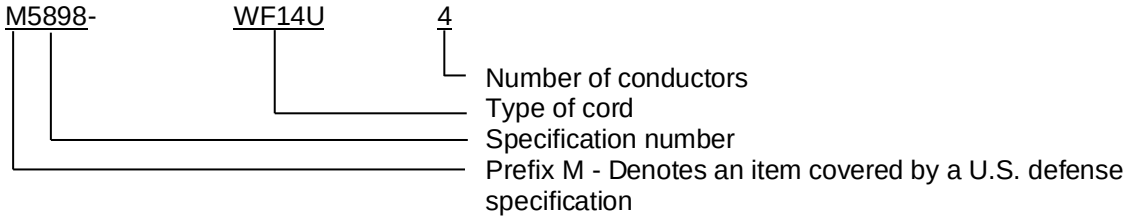
1.1 Scope. This specification covers conductor-insulated, jacketed, electrical cords used to fabricate combination headset-microphone extension cords and microphone extension cords for installation in defense aircraft equipped with intercommunication sets.

1.2 Classification. Cords are of the types specified in table I.

TABLE I. Types of cords.

Type	Number of conductors
WF-5/U	4
WF-14/U	4
WD-34/U	2
WM-53/U	5
WM-85/U	5

1.2.1 Part or Identifying Number (PIN). The PIN consists of the following form:



2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: DLA Land and Maritime, Columbus, Attn: VAI, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, Ohio, 43218-3990 or emailed to WireCable@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil/.

AMSC N/A FSC 6145

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2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL STANDARD

FED-STD-228	-	Test Methods for Cables and Wire, Insulated
FED-STD-313	-	Material Safety Data, Transportation Data, and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATION

MIL-PRF-572	-	Cord, Yarns and Monofilaments Organic Synthetic Fiber

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-104	-	Limits for Electrical Insulation Color
MIL-STD-1285	-	Marking of Electrical and Electronic Parts

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM B33	-	Standard Specification forTin-Coated Soft or Annealed Copper Wire for Electrical Purposes
ASTM C930	-	Standard Classification of Potential Health and Safety Concerns Associated With Thermal Insulation Materials and Accessories
ASTM G21	-	Standard Practice for Determining Resistance of Synthetic Polymeric Materials to Fungi

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org.)

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ISO International Standards

ISO/IEC 17025 - General requirements for the competence of testing and calibration laboratories

(Copies of these documents are available online https://www.iso.org.)

NATIONAL ELECTRICAL MANUFACTURERS ASSOCIATION (NEMA)

NEMA-WC 70 - Power Cables Rated 2000 Volts or Less for the Distribution of Electrical Energy

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.nema.org.)

UNDERWRITERS LABORATORIES, INCORPORATED (UL)

UL 2556 - Wire and Cable Test Methods

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.ul.com.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials. Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.3 Materials (see 4.6.1). The material for each part shall be as specified herein. When a definite material is not specified, a material shall be used which enables the electrical cord to meet the requirements of this specification. Acceptance or approval of any constituent material shall not be construed as acceptance of this finished product.

3.3.1 Flammable, explosive or toxic materials. In normal usage, materials shall be non-flammable, non-explosive, and nontoxic over the operating temperature range of this specification. Materials used in construction of these cords shall not emit fumes, powder or particles visible to the naked eye when cut, bent or otherwise manipulated during installation or normal use.

3.3.2 Coatings, jackets and other coverings. Materials used for coatings, jackets or coverings shall not exhibit defects such as checks, cracks, splits, blisters, pimples, embedded materials or pinholes when examined visually.

3.3.3 Material integrity. Materials and component parts of these cords shall exhibit no abnormalities or defects such as decomposition, separation or deterioration when examined visually.

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3.4 Insulated conductors.

3.4.1 Individual strands (see 4.6.1). The individual strands shall be American Wire Gauge (AWG) 40 bronze alloy wire and shall be tinned in accordance with ASTM B33 before bunching. The minimum tensile strength of the strands after tinning shall be 90,000 pounds per square inch and shall be of at least 80 percent conductivity grade. Do not use cadmium.

3.4.2 Conductors (see 4.6.1). The conductors shall be bunch stranded and the lay of the strands shall be approximately one-half inch. The nominal area of each conductor shall be 442 circular mils and the minimum area shall be 430 circular mils.

3.4.3 Wrap (see 4.6.1). Wrapping material shall in accordance with MIL-PRF-572. The yarn may be omitted provided the conductors in the finished cords are free stripping and free from any detrimental effects that will interfere with normal soldering of the strands of the conductors in the finished cord.

3.4.4 Insulation (see 4.6.1). The insulation compound for the individual conductors shall be formulated to provide a material that meets the electrical, air-aging, and bending requirements specified herein.

3.4.4.1 Physical requirements (see 4.6.1 and 4.6.12). The insulation shall show no evidence of cracking or other damage, and the insulated conductor shall be flexible and resilient throughout the temperature range from -55 to 85 °C. The thickness of the insulation at any point along the conductor shall be not less than .010 inch (.254mm).

3.4.4.2 Outside diameter of insulated conductor (see 4.6.1). The outside diameter of the insulated conductor shall be .060 inch (1.52 mm) nominal.

3.4.5 Insulation color (see 4.6.1). The insulation of individual conductors shall be colored as specified in table II. The colors shall be class 1, nominal chip, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-104.

TABLE II. Insulation color of individual conductors.

Conductor number	WF-5/U	WF-14/U	WD-34/D	WM-53/U	WM-85/U
1	White	Red	Red	White	Red
2	Red	Green	Green	Red	Green
3	Green	White	-	Green	White
4	Black	Black	-	Black	Black
5	-	-	-	Yellow	Yellow

3.5 Copper braid (see 4.6.1). Copper braid, where used, shall be fabric cored and shall be composed of eight carriers of AWG 36 tinned copper wire, three ends per carrier, having a height of spiral of .200 ±.020 inch (5.08 ±.508mm). The tinned copper wire shall be in accordance with ASTM B33. The fabric core shall be fungus-resistant cotton, and the finished braid shall be capable of 2,000 flexing cycles without causing electrical discontinuity when tested in accordance with 4.6.7.3.

3.6 Staycord (see 4.6.1 and 4.6.8). Staycord shall be braided of fungus-resistant cotton threads. The staycord for all cords except type WD-34 shall have a diameter of .052 ±.010 inch (1.32 ±.254mm) and shall have a breaking strength of not less than 30 pounds. The staycord for cord type WD-34 shall have a maximum diameter of .055 inches (1.4mm) and shall have a breaking strength of not less than 15 pounds. The staycord shall not damage the insulation of the conductors when the cord is bent or stretched.

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3.7 Cabling.

3.7.1 Cabling of WF-14/U cord (see 4.6.1).

a. The red and green conductors shall be twisted together with a left-hand lay of approximately .750 inch (19mm). The white and black conductors shall be twisted together with a left-hand lay of approximately 1.250 inches (31.8mm).

b. A close wind consisting of a minimum of 32 ends of conducting cotton shall be applied over each twisted pair. The conducting-cotton wind shall be constructed of fungus-resistant number 60, 2-ply yarn having a maximum resistance of 1.2 megohms per inch. The maximum resistance of the wind in the completed cord shall be 1.5 megohms per foot. Alternatively, spirally served #36 AWG soft tinned copper alloy shields may be used.

c. The two conducting-cotton-wrapped or spirally served copper alloy shielded pairs shall be twisted together with a right-hand lay of approximately 1.500 inches (38.1mm) with a copper braid in one interstice and a staycord in the other interstice. Fungus-resistant cotton filler shall be used in each interstice to give the cord a reasonably circular cross section. The two pairs and the copper braid shall be twisted in such a manner as to assure contact between the braid and both conducting-cotton wraps or both shielded pairs.

3.7.2 Cabling of WM-85/U cord (see 4.6.1). The cabling of cord WM-85/U shall be as specified in 3.7.1a through 3.7.1c, except that a yellow conductor shall be used in the interstice with the staycord.

3.7.3 Cabling of WM-53/U cord (see 4.6.1). Five conductors in the order specified in table II shall be spiraled around a central core with a lay of approximately .531 inch (13.5mm). The central core shall contain a staycord. The conductors shall be wrapped around the central core in such a manner as to provide relatively free movement of the conductors over the staycord when the finished cord is bent or stretched.

3.7.4 Cabling of WF-5/U cord (see 4.6.1). The cabling of cord WF-5/U shall be as specified in 3.7.3, except the yellow conductor shall not be used.

3.7.5 Cabling of WD-34/U cord (see 4.6.1).

a. The two conductors as specified in table II shall be twisted together with two staycords with approximately .500 inch (12.7mm) left-hand lay.

b. A close wrap of fine fungus-resistant cotton shall be applied with a right-hand lay over the cabled assembly.

3.8 Jacket (see 4.6.1). After cabling, the assembly shall be covered overall and shall be centered in a jacketing compound formulated so as to fulfill the requirements specified herein. The jacketing material shall not adhere to the conductor insulation. Optionally, a thin, fungus-resistant, cotton wrapping may be applied over the assembly before the jacket is applied, provided flexibility is maintained in the finished cord. After jacketing, the cord shall be reasonably smooth, firmly bound, tough, elastic, and a homogeneous mass.

3.8.1 Jacketing compound (see 4.6.1 and 4.6.12). The jacketing compound shall be a low-temperature polychloroprene, crosslinked polyolefin, or polyurethane, and shall meet the material and physical property as specified in table III and the operating temperature range and cold bend requirements specified herein when tested as specified in 4.6.4.1, 4.6.4.2, and 4.6.4.3.

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TABLE III. Physical property requirements for jacketing compounds of finished cord.

Jacket wall thickness inch/(mm)	Less than .020/(.51)	.020 to .030 (.51 to .762)	Greater than .030/(.76)
Unaged:			
Tensile strength, minimum, lbf/in^2	1200	1500	1800
Elongation, minimum, percent	250	250	300
Set, maximum, inch(mm)	-	-	.375(9.52)
After 166 hours of air-aging at 70 °C:			
Tensile strength, minimum, percent of original	75	75	75
Elongation, minimum, percent of original	75	75	75
After oil immersion:			
Tensile strength, minimum, percent of original	50	50	50
Elongation, minimum, percent of original	50	50	50

3.8.2 Jacket wall thickness (see 4.6.1). The minimum wall thickness of the jacket shall be as specified in table IV.

3.9 Outside diameter of cord (see 4.6.1). The outside diameter of the finished cord shall be as specified in table IV.

TABLE IV. Jacket wall thickness and cord outside diameter.

Cord type:	WF-5/U	WF-14/U	WD-34/U	WM-53/U	WM-85/U
Jacket minimum thickness, inch (mm)	.025 (.635)	.025 (.635)	.012 (.305)	.025 (.635)	.025 (.635)
Cord outside diameter, ±.010 inch (mm)	.280 (7.11)	.300 (7.62)	.160 (4.06)	.280 (7.11)	.305 (7.75)

3.10 Flexing. When tested as specified in 4.6.7.2, the finished cord shall be capable of withstanding at least 25,000 flexing cycles without showing evidence of serious damage to the jacket such as splits or ruptures, damage to the insulation of the individual conductors, or electrical discontinuity or short circuit.

3.11 Fungus-resistance (see 4.6.3). Materials used that are not fungus-inert shall be treated so as to render the material fungus-resistant. The fungicide used shall have no detrimental effects on the finished cord.

3.12 Electrical requirements of finished cord.

3.12.1 Dielectric strength. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.2, The insulation on conductors shall withstand the application of 500 V ac at 60 Hz for 5 seconds without flashover or breakdown.

3.12.2 Insulation resistance. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.3, the insulation resistance shall be not less than 100 megohms-1,000 feet at 15.6 °C.

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3.12.3 Conductor resistance. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.1, the resistance per conductor per 100 feet shall not exceed 4.0 Ω.

3.12.4 Isolation. When tested as specified in 4.6.9, the minimum isolation of cords WF-14/U and WM-85/U shall be as specified in table V.

TABLE V. Isolation.

Frequency (Hz)	Electrostatic		Electromagnetic	
	WF-14/U	WM-85/U	WF-14/U	WM-85/U
	(dB minimum)		(dB minimum)	
20,000	62.0	60.0	48.0	45.0
15,000	63.0	60.5	49.0	45.0
10,000	64.0	61.0	50.0	45.0
5,000	65.0	61.5	51.0	45.0
1,000	66.0	62.0	51.0	46.0

3.13 Identification (see 4.6.1). The cord shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-1285 on the jacket at 12 to 24 inch intervals throughout the entire length. The identification marking shall read lengthwise along the cord as specified in table VI.

3.14 Insulation shrinkage. When tinning the wire of the finished cord and tested as specified in 4.6.10, the insulation shall not shrink more than .031 inch lengthwise and shall not expand outward from the wire.

3.15 Ozone resistance. When tested as specified in 4.6.11, the finished cord shall be ozone-resistant.

TABLE VI. Markings for identification.

Cord type	PIN	Defense specification no.	Manufacturer name or CAGE Code 1/
WF-5/U	M5898-WF5U4	MIL-DTL-5898	*
WF-14/U	M5898-WF14U4	MIL-DTL-5898	*
WD-34/U	M5898-WD34U2	MIL-DTL-5898	*
WM-53/U	M5898-WM53U5	MIL-DTL-5898	*
WM-85/U	M5898-WM85U5	MIL-DTL-5898	*

1/ Applicable information to be supplied by the manufacturer.

3.16 Flammability. When subjected to an open flame as specified in UL 2556 and 4.6.5., the wire shall not be judged capable of conveying flame along its length and shall not be judged capable of conveying flame to combustible materials in its vicinity. Where any specimen shows more than 25 percent of the indicator flag burned away or charred (soot that can be removed with a cloth or the fingers, and brown scorching, are to be ignored) after any of the five applications of flame, the wire, cable, or cord is to be judged capable of conveying flame along its length. Where any specimen emits flaming or glowing particles or flaming drops at any time that ignite the cotton on the bottom of the test chamber (flameless charring of the cotton is to be ignored), or continues to flame longer than 60 s after any application of the gas flame, the wire, cable, or cord is to be judged capable of conveying flame to combustible materials in its vicinity. Where any specimen emits flaming or glowing particles or flaming drops at any time that fall outside the area of the testing surface covered by the cotton and/or that fall onto the wedge or burner, the test results are to be discarded and the test is to be repeated.

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3.17 Cold bend. When tested as specified in 4.6.12, the cord shall show no evidence of cracked jacket or conductor insulation when subjected to cold bending at -55 +0, -5 °C.

3.18 Workmanship (see 4.6.1). The electrical cord supplied to this specification shall be of high quality workmanship. It shall be homogenous throughout its length, free of irregularities and free of defects that affect its life, serviceability, or appearance The cord shall be uniform in shape and free of kinks, splints, cuts, cracks, abrasions, peeled surfaces, or other imperfections.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.2 Test equipment and inspection facilities. Test and measuring equipment and inspection facilities of sufficient accuracy, quality, and quantity to permit performance of the required inspections shall be used. The establishment and maintenance of a calibration system to control the accuracy of the measuring and test equipment shall be in accordance with ISO/IEC 17025 or equivalent.

4.3 Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified in the applicable test method, inspections shall be conducted under the following environmental conditions.

a. Temperature: 15 to 35 °C.

b. Pressure: Normal atmospheric.

c. Humidity: Prevailing ambient (25 to 90 percent relative).

4.4 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2), first article inspection shall consist of the tests specified in table VII and shall be performed by the supplier, after award of contract and prior to production, at a location acceptable to the Government. First article inspection shall be performed on sample units which have been produced with equipment and procedures normally used in production. First article approval is valid only on the contract or purchase order under which it is granted, unless extended by the Government to other contracts or purchase orders.

4.5 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall consist of group A (see 4.5.2) and group B (see 4.5.3) inspections, and shall be performed on every lot of cord procured under this specification.

4.5.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all cord of the same PIN, produced under essentially the same conditions, and presented for inspection at one time.

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TABLE VII. First article inspection.

Inspection	Requirement	Verification paragraph
Conductor:	3.4	-
Strands, conductors, wrap	3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.3	4.6.1
Insulation	3.4.4	4.6.1
Material	3.3, 3.4.1, 3.4.3	4.6.1
Physical requirements	3.4.4.1	4.6.1 and 4.6.12
Insulation thickness	3.4.4.1	4.6.1
Outside diameter	3.4.4.2	4.6.1
Color	3.4.5	4.6.1
Copper braid	3.5	4.6.1 and 4.6.7.3
Staycord:	3.6	-
Material		4.6.1
Breaking strength		4.6.8
Dimensions		4.6.1
Conducting cotton / Spirally served copper alloy shields	3.7.1b	4.6.1
Cabling:	3.7.1 through 3.7.5	4.6.1
Conductors		
Lay		
Filler		
Wrap		
Jacket	3.8	4.6.1
Jacketing compound	3.8.1	4.6.1 and 4.6.12
Jacket wall thickness	3.8.2	4.6.1
Cord:	-	-
Outside diameter	3.9	4.6.1
Identification	3.13	4.6.1
Wrap	3.4.3	4.6.1
Environmental	-	-
Tensile strength/elongation/set		
Unaged	3.8.1	4.6.4.1
Air-aged	3.8.1	4.6.4.2
Oil immersion	3.8.1	4.6.4.3
Flammability	3.16	4.6.5
Ozone resistance 1/	3.15	4.6.11
Flexing, cord	3.10	4.6.7.2
Flexing, braid	3.5	4.6.7.3
Fungus resistance	3.11	4.6.3
Insulation shrinkage	3.14	4.6.10
Cold bend	3.17	4.6.12
Electrical; cord:	3.12	-
Conductor resistance	3.12.3	4.6.6.1
Insulation resistance	3.12.2	4.6.6.3
Dielectric strength	3.12.1	4.6.6.2
Isolation	3.12.4	4.6.9
Workmanship	3.18	4.6.1

1/ The ozone-resistance test is not required if polyurethane or a crosslinked-polyolefin material is used for the jacketing compound.

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4.5.1.1 Unit of product. The unit of product shall be a continuous length of cord, not to exceed 550 feet in length.

4.5.2 Group A inspection. Group A inspection shall consist of the inspections specified below. Group A inspection may be performed at an appropriate stage of the manufacturing operation rather than on the finished cord.

a. Conductor resistance.

b. Dielectric strength.

c. Insulation resistance.

d. Workmanship.

4.5.3 Group B inspection. Group B inspection shall consist of the inspections in table VIII conducted on a sampling basis.

TABLE VIII. Group B inspection.

Inspection	Requirement	Verification
Identification	3.13	4.6.1
Outside diameter of conductor	3.4.4.2	4.6.1
Outside diameter of cord	3.9	4.6.1
Staycord, diameter	3.6	4.6.1
Staycord, breaking strength	3.6	4.6.8
Isolation	3.12.4	4.6.9

4.5.3.1 Sampling. A random sample shall be selected from each lot. The sample size shall be based on the lot size from which the sample was selected. Sampling inspection shall be as specified in table IX.

TABLE IX. Inspection sample.

Lot size 1/	Sample Size
1 to 8	2
9 to 90	3
91 to 150	12
151 to 280	19
281 to 500	21
501 to 1,200	27
1,201 to 3,200	36
3,201 to 10,000	38
10,001 to 35,000	46

1/ Lot size is based on the number of units of product (see 4.5.1.1).

4.5.3.2 Specimen length. Unless otherwise specified herein, the specimen shall be of the length specified in the applicable test method.

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4.5.4 Rejected lot. Failure of a lot to pass any test or inspection constitutes failure of the lot and the lot shall be rejected. If an inspection lot is rejected, the contractor may rework the lot to correct the defects, or screen out the defective units and resubmit the lot for re-inspection. Such lots shall be separated from new lots and shall be identified as re-inspected lots.

4.5.5 Non compliance. If a sample fails to pass group B inspection (see 4.5.3), the contractor shall notify the cognizant inspection activity of such failure and take corrective action on the materials or processes, or both, as warranted, on all units of the product. Acceptance and shipment of the product shall be discontinued until corrective action has been taken. After the corrective action has been taken, sampling inspection shall be repeated on replacement articles. (This includes all tests and examinations, or only the test that the original sample failed, at the option of the cognizant inspection activity.) Final acceptance and shipment will be withheld until group B inspection has shown that the corrective action was successful. In the event of failure after re-inspection, information concerning the failure shall be provided to the cognizant inspection activity.

4.6 Methods of inspection.

4.6.1 Visual and dimensional inspection. The finished cords shall be given a visual and dimensional inspection for:

a. Color of conductors (3.4.5).

b. Identification (3.13).

c. Workmanship (3.18).

d. Outside diameter of insulated conductors (3.4.4.2).

e. Thickness of conductor insulation (3.4.4.1).

f. Minimum wall thickness of jacketing material (3.8.2).

g. Outside diameter of finished cords (3.9).

h. Staycord diameter and material (3.6).

i. Wrap (3.4.3).

j. Cabling (conductors, lay, filler, wrap, and conducting cotton / spiral served copper alloy shielded pairs) (3.7.1 through 3.7.5).

k. Braid (3.5).

l. Insulated conductors (strands, conductors, insulation, and material) (3.3, 3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.4).

m. Jacketing composition (3.8, 3.8.1).

4.6.2 Air-aging and bending. A specimen of insulated conductor shall be selected from each 20,000 feet of cord or one month's production, whichever is less, and shall be air-aged in an oven and tested in accordance with NEMA-WC 70, except that the aging period and temperature shall be as specified in table III. After aging, the specimen shall be wrapped five times around a .156-inch (3.96mm) diameter mandrel.

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4.6.3 Fungus resistance (see 3.11). A cord specimen shall be selected from each 250,000 feet of cord or six months' production, whichever is less, and shall be subjected to a fungus test in accordance with ASTM G21.

4.6.4 Jacket tensile strength, elongation, and set.

4.6.4.1 Unaged (see 3.8.1). An unaged jacket shall be tested for tensile strength using method 3021 of FED-STD-228 and for elongation using method 3031 of FED-STD-228. Set, when required, shall be tested using method 3161 of FED-STD-228.

4.6.4.2 Air-aged (see 3.8.1). A sample of the jacket shall be air-aged for 166 hours at 70 °C and then tested for tensile strength and elongation using the methods listed in 4.6.4.1.

4.6.4.3 Oil immersion (see 3.8.1). The jacket shall be subjected to the oil immersion test in accordance with method 4223 of FED-STD-228.

4.6.5 Flammability (see 3.16). Insulation flammability testing shall be performed in accordance with the VW-1 flame test method of UL 2556.

4.6.6 Electrical tests.

4.6.6.1 Conductor resistance (see 3.12.3). The resistance of each conductor of the cord shall be measured in a bridge circuit. The arithmetical average of the measured values shall be used to calculate the conductor resistance.

4.6.6.2 Dielectric strength. An alternating potential as specified in 3.12.1 shall be applied between two terminals, one being each conductor in turn and the other terminal being all the remaining conductors tied together. The voltage source shall have a capacity of not less than 3 kilovolt ampere.

4.6.6.3 Insulation resistance (see 3.12.2). Immediately after successfully passing the dielectric strength test, the insulation resistance shall be measured using a galvanometer with shunts and a dc voltage source of not less than 125 V dc. The connections shall be as specified in 4.6.6.2. The test may be terminated when the galvanometer indicates a steady insulation resistance value has been obtained. The measured insulation resistance values shall be corrected to 15.6 °C if measurements are made at temperature other than 15.6 °C.

4.6.7 Flexing test. Sample lengths of cord shall be selected from each 100,000 feet or one month's production, whichever is less, and subjected to the following:

4.6.7.1 Preparation. Five specimens, each approximately 1.5 feet long, shall be clamped and suspended through holes in a rectangular .500x.625 inch (12.7mm x 15.9mm) metal bar. The diameter of the .625-inch (15.9mm) through holes shall be .005 inch (.13mm) to .010 inch (.254mm) greater than the diameter of the cord undergoing the test. The through holes shall incorporate a .125-inch (3.17mm) radius at the end from which the cords emerge (bending point). The cords shall be clamped in such a manner that they will not turn in the holes during flexing. The clamping points shall be immediately above the metal bar and cord clamps shall rest on top of the metal bar. A knot shall be tied near the free end of each cord and a 3-pound weight shall be suspended from each knot, except for type WD-34/U, which shall have a 1-pound weight suspended from each knot. The metal bar, supported horizontally, shall be positioned in a test jig that will enable oscillation about its longitudinal axis through an angle or 120° (60°each side of vertical).

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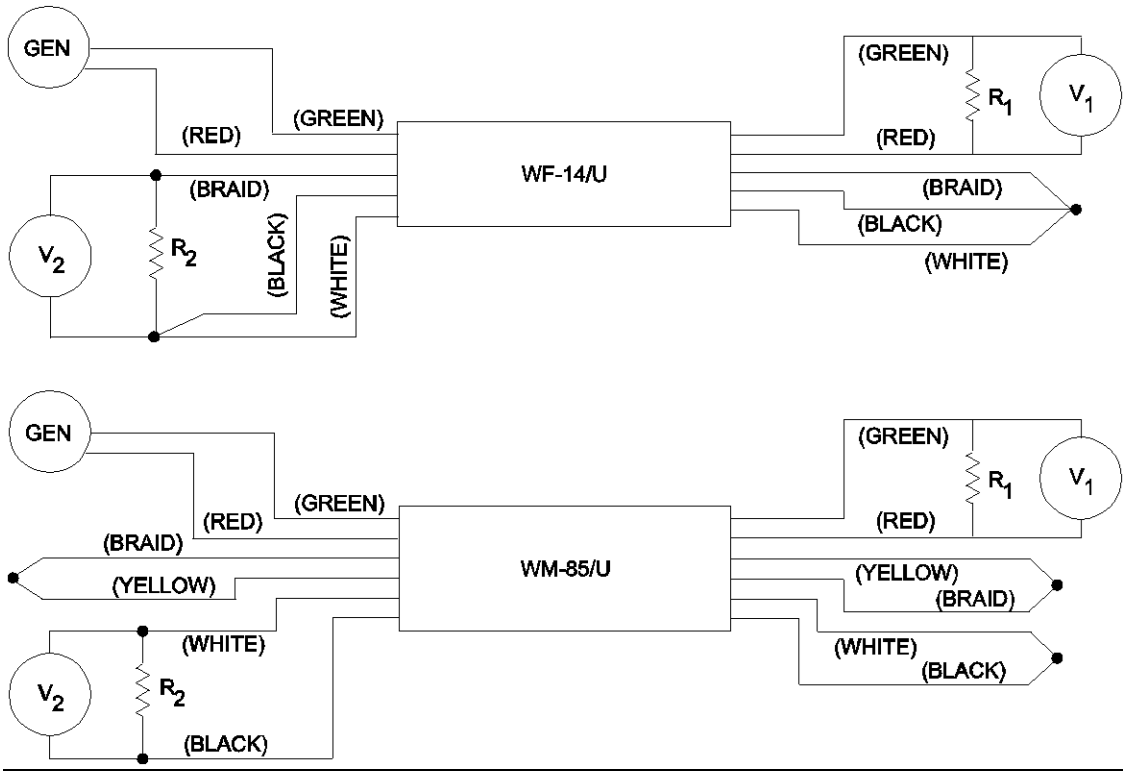
4.6.7.2 Cord flexing life (see 3.10). The conductors of each specimen shall be connected in series with a 6-volt lamp and a suitable power supply to indicate electrical continuity. The metal bar shall then be oscillated at approximately 85 cycles per minute until electrical discontinuity occurs. The cord flexing life shall be calculated by summing the total number of flexing cycles for each specimen and dividing by the total number of specimens.

4.6.7.3 Braid flexing life (see 3.5). Where used, the copper braid of each specimen shall be connected in series with the circuit described in 4.6.7.2. The metal bar shall be oscillated at approximately 85 cycles per minute until electrical discontinuity occurs. The arithmetical average of the number of flexing cycles per specimen shall be taken as the braid flexing life.

4.6.8 Staycord strength (see 3.6). A suitable device shall be used to determine the breaking strength of the staycord.

4.6.9 Isolation tests (see 3.12.4). A specimen of 55 feet ±2 inches (16800 ±50.8 mm) shall be tested in the appropriate circuit as shown on figure 1 for both electrostatic and electromagnetic isolation. Calculations shall be as shown on figure 1.

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Calculations: dB = dBm reading of V_1 - dBm reading of V_2

NOTES:

1. For electrostatic tests: $R_1 = R_2 = 1$ megohm ±5%.

2. For electromagnetic tests: $R_1 = 4.5\Omega$ ±1%.
   $R_2 = 1$ megohm ±5%.

3. The waveform shall be sinusoidal, 15 V_{rms} minimum.

FIGURE 1. Isolation tests.

4.6.10 Insulation shrinkage (see 3.14). The outer jacket shall be stripped approximately 3 inches and each individual wire stripped approximately .250 inch (6.4mm). The bare wires shall be twisted by hand and remain at its minimum diameter in five twists or less and shall not spread or fray at the end. The wires shall be tinned and soldered in accordance with FED-STD-228, method 8231.

4.6.11 Ozone resistance (see 3.15). The cord shall be wrapped around a mandrel that is four times the outside diameter of the specimen in such a manner that the cord is kept taut throughout the test. The mandrels and specimens shall be kept at room temperature for 2 days, after which these items shall be placed in an atmosphere containing 25 ±5 parts of ozone per one-hundred million parts of air. A temperature of 50 °C shall be maintained and the test continued for a period of 7 days. After the test has been completed, the jacket of the specimen shall be inspected for cracking through a magnifying glass of at least three diameters magnification.

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4.6.12 Cold bend (see 3.4.4.1, 3.8.1, and 3.17). The cord shall be attached to the proper size mandrel as specified in table X and suspended vertically with the lower ends weighted sufficiently to keep the cord taut and to permit bending without handling. The cord and mandrel shall be placed in a chamber at -55 +0, -5 °C for a minimum of 20 hours. While maintaining the cord at -55 °C, the cord shall be bent for 5 close turns around the mandrel at the rate of approximately 15 turns per minute. The jacket shall then be examined for cracks using a magnifying glass of at least 3 diameters magnification. After examination of the jacket, the jacket shall be removed and the conductor insulation examined for cracks using the same magnifying glass.

TABLE X. Mandrel size for cold bend test.

Cord type	Maximum mandrel size
WF-5/U WD-34/U WM-53/U	1 times cord OD
WF-14/U WM-85/U	3 times cord OD

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The cords covered by this specification are used to make up combination headset-microphone extension cords and microphone cords for installation in specific defense aircraft with intercommunication sets. These cords are defense unique because they are configured for use only in defense aircraft.

a. WM-85/U is used with plug connector U-94( ) U to make up combination headset-microphone extension cords with portable microphone switch.

b. WD-34/U is used as a microphone cord with the M-3A/A, M-32( ) AIC, and M-33( ) AIC microphones.

c. WF-5/U is used with jack U-61/U to make up headset-microphone extension cords.

d. WM-53/U is used with jack U-82/U to make up combination headset-microphone extension cords with a portable microphone switch.

e. WF-14/U is used with jack U-92( )/U to make up combination headset-microphone extension cords.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Type designation and PIN (see 1.2 and 1.2.1).

c. If required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2.1 and 2.3).

d. Whether first article inspection is required (see 3.1 and 4.4). Invitations for bids should provide that the government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection for those bidders offering a product that has been previously acquired or tested by the government, and that bidders offering such products who wish to rely on such production or test must furnish evidence with the bid that prior government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

e. Packaging requirements (see 5.1). The cords should be furnished on spools, in spool or reel-type packages, or on reels. Each spool, package, or reel should contain not less than 450 feet and not more than 550 feet. The maximum number of continuous lengths per spool, package, or reel should be 3. The length of any one piece thereof should not be less than 50 feet.

6.2.1 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors, whether the item(s) should be a preproduction sample, a first article sample, a first production item, a sample selected from the first production items, a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory (see 3.1), and the number of items to be tested as specified in 4.4. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.3 Material handling and disposal. Caution should be taken during handling and disposal of all insulation and jacket materials in accordance with ASTM C930 and FED-STD-313.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Flexible
Headset
Microphone

6.5 Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

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CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Air Force - 85
DLA - CC

Preparing activity:
DLA - CC

(Project 6145-2024-012)

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